

MAHATMA GANDHI: EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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Mahatma Gandhi: Executive Summary

Core Identity

- **Full Name:** Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi
- **Titles:** Mahatma (Great Soul), Bapu (Father of the Nation)
- **Born:** October 2, 1869, Porbandar, Gujarat
- **Died:** January 30, 1948, New Delhi (assassinated)

Political Role

- Primary leader of the Indian National Movement.
- Served as the first Indian leader to negotiate directly with the British Empire on equal footing.
- Instrumental in India's independence from British rule in 1947.

Key Ideologies

- **Ahimsa:** Absolute non-violence.
- **Satyagraha:** Truth-force or soul-force; non-violent resistance to evil.
- **Swadeshi:** Self-reliance and the promotion of indigenous industries (e.g., Khadi).
- **Sarvodaya:** Welfare of all.

Major Movements

- **Champaran Satyagraha (1917):** First major campaign in India.
- **Non-Cooperation Movement (1920-22):** Boycott of British institutions.
- **Salt March (1930):** 240-mile march to Dandi to defy the salt tax.
- **Quit India Movement (1942):** Call for immediate British withdrawal.

Legacy

- Inspired global civil rights leaders, including Martin Luther King Jr. and Nelson Mandela.
- Model for non-violent political action worldwide.

Key Definitions

- **Satyagraha:** A method of resistance based on truth and non-violence.
- **Ahimsa:** The principle of non-violence toward all living beings.
- **Khadi:** Hand-spun cloth, promoted by Gandhi to symbolize self-reliance and economic independence.
- **Harijan:** A term used by Gandhi to refer to the 'untouchables' or Dalits, aiming to destigmatize the community.